

KIMBERLY (KIM) BELL

SENIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER IN TEST (SDET)

Winston-Salem, NC | 336-782-1868 | krbell4@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/kimbell4 | kimbell.me | github.com/TzolkinB

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

With 8+ years of software experience, I bring a developer's mindset to quality engineering, architecting automation frameworks that teams adopt, and building cross-team collaboration that bridges QA and engineering. I practice shift-left testing by design, embedding test planning early in Agile sprints, integrating test gates into CI/CD pipelines, and covering responsive behavior in automation so quality is built in from the start. Currently working in Playwright while actively seeking Senior SDET or QA Engineer roles.

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: JavaScript, Typescript, React

Testing: Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Testing Library, E2E, Integration, Regression, API, Accessibility, Responsive, SQL (working knowledge)

CI/CD & Tools: Github Copilot, Git, Gitlab CI/CD, Github Actions, Bitbucket, BrowserStack, LogRocket, Jira, Confluence, qTest

CONTINUOUS LEARNING & PROJECTS

Independent Study & Projects

Dec 2025 - May 2026

playwright-test-collection - github.com/TzolkinB/playwright-test-collection

Converted an existing Cypress test suite to Playwright using Typescript and Github Actions, demonstrating hands-on framework migration. Used Github Copilot to accelerate test code generation and debug test failures. Covers UI integration tests and REST API tests, with shared fixtures and helper abstractions to eliminate duplication across spec files.

loop-playwright - github.com/TzolkinB/loop-playwright

[LoopQA](#): Built a data-driven Playwright test suite using the Page Object Model (POM), JSON-based test data, and Typescript enums for type-safe parameterization. Supports both web and mobile views, includes login/auth setup, and is designed for scalability. New test scenarios can be added through data files without requiring changes to the test code.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Sabbatical - Medical leave; Available for full-time roles.

Jan 2024 - Nov 2025

Ally Financial, Charlotte, NC

Senior SDET - Remote

Jan 2022 - Dec 2023

Architected and scaled test automation across 10 teams, shifting 35 repositories from manual to 90% automated testing within 2 years. Established automation best practices, accelerated test development by 75%, and enabled consistent 2-week release cycles. As the technical lead and primary escalation point for framework issues, I partnered with product and engineering teams to align workflows and eliminate bottlenecks.

- Led transition from 100% manual to 90% automated testing across 10 teams in 2 years using Cypress, Testing Library, TypeScript, and Gitlab CI/CD, reducing regression effort and enabling consistent 2-week release cycles
- Designed and scaled test automation across 35 repositories (from 11) serving 10 engineering teams; standardized automation practices and framework adoption
- Integrated UI automation into Gitlab CI/CD pipelines, reducing release hardening time from hours to minutes and ensuring on-schedule sprint deployments

- Built and scaled reusable Cypress (with Testing Library) commands and testing standards, accelerating test development by 75% and enabling consistent execution across teams
- Reduced test flakiness across 10 teams by implementing mocking strategies for environmental dependencies (feature flags, API contract changes) using Cypress, Testing Library and Typescript, establishing common test patterns with built-in guards for test stability
- Led QA platform team's Jira board migration from Kanban to Agile sprints, leveraging feature team experience to bridge both workflows and align QA cadence with feature team sprint cycles, reducing cross-team friction

Ally Financial, Charlotte, NC

Software Engineer

Dec 2018 - Dec 2021

Joined during Ally's critical Ember-to-React migration, developing features across 2+ ecosystems while simultaneously leading the parallel effort to migrate and modernize automated tests. Became the subject matter expert on Cypress, training teams and accelerating tool adoption across the organization.

- Delivered frontend features across Ember and React ecosystems during a large-scale migration, balancing feature delivery with modernization; validated work using Jest and BrowserStack prior to QA handoff
- Championed Cypress adoption by participating in proof-of-concept, then leading training and establishing foundational testing patterns that became the standard across the organization
- Led migration of automated tests to align with React architecture, maintaining test coverage and stability during platform transition
- Leveraged Swagger for API validation during integration, creating mocks and diagnosing UI issues arising from API contract modifications

REASON CONSULTING CORPORATION (previously Tax Management Associates), Charlotte, NC

Software Engineer

Jan 2018 - Nov 2018

Accelerated UI/UX development processes, providing technical training and building React applications that bridged design concepts with production-ready code.

- Trained UI/UX designers in React, improving design-to-development workflow and reducing iteration friction
- Built 2 production React applications, translating requirements into scalable, user-facing solutions

REASON CONSULTING CORPORATION (previously Tax Management Associates), Charlotte, NC

Junior Frontend Developer / Apprentice

Oct 2015 - Dec 2017

- Contributed to frontend development using JavaScript and React, supporting delivery of user-facing applications in an Agile environment

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (MA), International Human Rights, University of Denver, Denver, CO

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Anthropology, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC